



Broken blade



Tapering quillons curving away from guard

▲ FRENCH SWORD

Date 14th century CE

Origin France

Weight 1.16kg (2½lb)

Length 85.7cm (33¼in)

As plate armour became more common in the 14th century, swords had to adapt to deal with it. This powerful sword has a double-edged blade that is wide at the hilt and tapers rapidly to a sharp point that could penetrate gaps in an opponent's armour.



Sharply tapered point

▲ ITALIAN SWORD

Date c.1400CE

Origin Italy

Weight 760g (27¼oz)

Length 1.04m (3½ft)

This sword was deposited in the Arsenal of Alexandria by the Egyptian Mamluk Sultan in 1432. It has a broad, flat blade and a short, sharp point – a style that became more common in the mid-16th century.



Ricasso

▼ ENGLISH HAND-AND-A-HALF SWORD

Date Early 15th century CE

Origin England

Weight 1.54kg (3½lb)

Length 1.19m (4ft)

Also known as a "bastard sword", this type of weapon had a long, slender blade, primarily for thrusting at an opponent. It had a long ricasso – an unsharpened length of blade – below the cross, allowing the bearer to grip this area with his left hand to deliver a powerful two-handed thrust.



Long, thin fuller



"Scent-stopper" pommel

▲ ENGLISH CASTILLON SWORD

Date Mid-15th century CE

Origin England

Weight 1kg (2¼lb)

Length 1.09m (3½ft)

This is one of around 80 swords found near the battlefield of Castillon, in France, where the French defeated the English in 1453. These swords mostly had sharply tapering points. Although the blade of this sword is heavily corroded, traces of the original wooden grip and gilding survive.

Blade heavily nicked and corroded

Sharp point for penetrating plate



◀ FLEMISH SWORD

Date 1460CE

Origin Southern Europe

Weight 1.34kg (3lb)

Length 88.3cm (34¾in)

Both the hilt and the pommel of this extremely ornate sword were gilded. The grip carved from black horn was made to flow into the fish-shaped pommel. The double-edged blade has four sides that taper to a very sharp point.



Broad blade with central fuller

Curved tip

▼ ENGLISH SHORT SWORD

Date 1480–1520CE

Origin England

Weight 570g (20½oz)

Length 69cm (27in)

Single-edged short swords were ideal for use against lightly armoured opponents and were often used by ordinary soldiers across northwest Europe in the 14th and 15th centuries. The backward-extending rear quillon provided additional protection for the gripping hand.

Rear quillon bent towards blade

Single-edged blade

